If you don't like something about a path you've drawn using the Pencil tool, you can adjust it using any of InDesign's other drawing tools. You might want to start with the other tools that share the same space in the Tools panel: the Smooth tool and the Eraser tool.

Smooth Tool ( )

First select a path and then drag the Smooth tool over it. It'll get smoother. Not smooth enough yet? Drag again. As you drag the Smooth tool, it adjusts the points and control handles that define the path to create a smoother transition from one line segment to another. It often removes points during this process. If you continue to repeat the smoothing process, we think you'll eventually end up with a simple curve between two points.

Eraser Tool ( )

The Eraser tool erases line segments and points. To use the Eraser tool, select a path, then drag the eraser tool over part of the path. It splits the path and removes the line segments and points where you dragged the Eraser tool.

Line Tool ( )

The Line tool is used to draw straight lines—paths containing two corner points. If you hold down **Shift** as you drag the Line tool, the lines you draw will be constrained to 0-, 45-, and 90-degree angles. Press \ (backslash) to select the Line tool.

Ellipse Tool ( )

The Ellipse tool draws ovals and circles. To draw an oval, click and drag. To draw a circle, press the **Shift** key while dragging.

Rectangle Tool ( )

The Rectangle tool draws both rectangles and squares. To draw a rectangle, click and drag. To constrain that rectangle to a square, press the **Shift** key while dragging (be sure to keep it pressed until you release the mouse button).

If you need a rectangle with rounded corners, draw the rectangle using the Rectangle tool, then choose **Corner Options** from the **Object** menu to display the **Corner Options** dialog box. The Corner options dialog box provides a variety of other corner shapes.

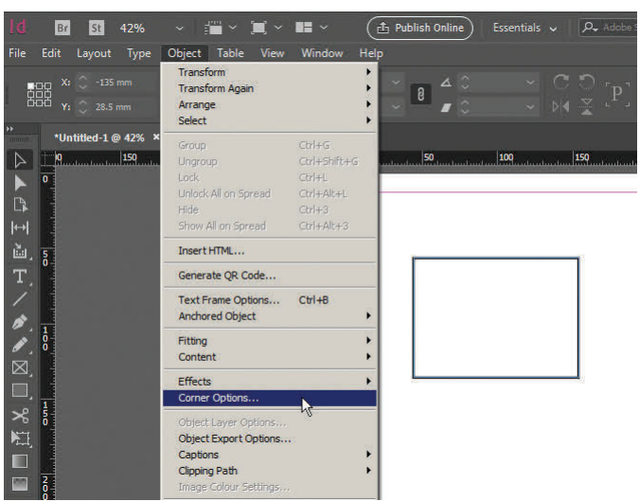


Figure 2.18 Object Menu

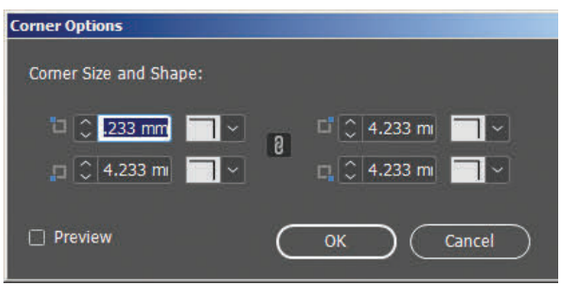


Figure 2.19 Corner Options dialog box

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